

IV. Vermiculture

X4N3B9

Vermiculture or Vermicomposting is a method of transforming organic wastes such as waste papers, leaves, pieces of woods etc., into a nutrient rich fertilizer using earth worms. It is a healthy and clean way to eliminate wastes going into our landfills. It keeps the environment clean. Earthworms eat the organic wastes and excrete it in the form of castings. This is known as vermicompost. It is used as fertilizer for the soil and it improves the properties of the soil.

1 Materials used for Vermicomposting

Organic matters which are biologically degradable are used in vermicomposting. Some of them are given below.



- Crop residues like rice straw, rice husk, tea wastes and tobacco wastes.
- Fruit and vegetable wastes.
- Animal wastes like cattle dung, poultry droppings and droppings of goat and sheep.

2 Advantages of Vermicompost

- Vermicompost provides the essential nutrients such as nitrogen, potassium and phosphorus. for the plant growth.
- It improves the water holding capacity of the soil and prevents soil erosion.
- It enhances plant growth, suppresses diseases in plants, increases porosity and improves water retention and aeration.
- It reduces the need for chemical fertilizers.



Do you know?

Common earth worms are not used for vermicomposting. Specialized breeds that multiple while living in colonies are used for this. The most common are Red wigglers, European night crawlers, and African night crawlers.



Evaluation

Z5D3S6

I. Choose the correct answer.

1. Which of the following produces more milk?

a) Cow b) Yak c) Buffalo d) Goat

2. Poultry farming is rearing and breeding of _____

a) chickens b) cows c) avian species d) animal

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